



Home Medical Reference

A Quick Guide to Indian Household Medicines

This handbook provides quick, easy-to-read information
on common over-the-counter and basic prescription
medications for emergency and household use.

VERSION: 1.0

GENERATED: JULY 27, 2026

Source Code: github.com/AbhiZx18324/medbook

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Quick Reference Guide

Lookup a primary symptom to find the recommended household medicine.

SYMPTOM / NEED	MEDICINE (BRAND)
Acidity	Gelusil
Acne	Benzac AC 2.5% Gel
Acute watery diarrhea	Imodium
Allergic rhinitis	Allegra 120
Blocked nose	Otrivin Oxy
Body aches	Combiflam
Bruises	Thrombophob
Constipation	Freego Powder
Cuts	Betadine Ointment
Dehydration	Electral
Dry cough	Ascoril D Plus
Dry eyes	Refresh Tears
Fever	Dolo 650
Minor burns	Silverex
Muscle pain	Volini
Small cuts	Hansaplast Washproof

SYMPTOM / NEED	MEDICINE (BRAND)
Sore throat	Strepsils
Sweat rash	Candid Dusting Powder

Acidity

Gelusil

OTC

Aluminum Hydroxide + Magnesium Hydroxide + Simethicone

USED FOR

- Acidity
- Heartburn
- Indigestion

HOW TO USE

Chew 1-2 tablets after meals or as needed

⚠ PRECAUTIONS

- Do not take within 2 hours of other medications

SIDE EFFECTS

- Constipation
- Diarrhea

SEE A DOCTOR IF

- Symptoms persist for more than 2 weeks
- Difficulty swallowing occurs

Benzac AC 2.5% Gel

OTC

Benzoyl Peroxide 2.5%

USED FOR

- Acne
- Pimples

HOW TO USE

Apply a small amount to affected area at night

⚠ PRECAUTIONS

- May bleach fabrics
- Use sunscreen during the day
- May cause dryness

SIDE EFFECTS

- Peeling
- Redness
- Dry skin

SEE A DOCTOR IF

- Severe skin irritation develops
- No improvement after 6 weeks of use

Allergy

Allegra 120

OTC

Fexofenadine 120 mg

USED FOR

- Allergic rhinitis
- Sneezing
- Runny nose
- Dust allergies

HOW TO USE

1 tablet once daily as needed

⚠ PRECAUTIONS

- Avoid taking with fruit juices (especially grapefruit or apple)

SIDE EFFECTS

- Mild headache
- Dry mouth

SEE A DOCTOR IF

- Symptoms persist despite use
- Signs of severe allergic reaction occur

Bruise & Vein Care

Thrombophob

OTC

Heparin Sodium + Benzyl Nicotinate

USED FOR

- Bruises
- Superficial thrombophlebitis
- Injection site reactions

HOW TO USE

Apply a thin layer to the affected area 2-3 times daily

⚠ PRECAUTIONS

- Do not apply to open wounds or broken skin
- For external use only

SIDE EFFECTS

- Local skin irritation
- Redness

SEE A DOCTOR IF

- Condition does not improve
- Severe skin irritation develops

Burn Care

Silverex

OTC

Silver Nitrate Gel

USED FOR

- Minor burns

HOW TO USE

Apply after cooling burn under running water for 10 minutes

⚠ PRECAUTIONS

- For external use only
- Avoid contact with eyes

SIDE EFFECTS

- Temporary skin staining
- Mild local irritation

SEE A DOCTOR IF

- Burn is severe or covers a large area
- Signs of infection appear

Constipation

Freego Powder

OTC

Lactitol Monohydrate + Ispaghula Husk

USED FOR

- Constipation

HOW TO USE

Use as directed

⚠ PRECAUTIONS

- Drink plenty of water

SIDE EFFECTS

- Bloating
- Flatulence
- Abdominal cramps

SEE A DOCTOR IF

- Constipation persists for more than 1 week
- Rectal bleeding occurs
- Severe abdominal pain

Cough

Ascoril D Plus

OTC

Dextromethorphan + Chlorpheniramine + Phenylephrine

USED FOR

- Dry cough

HOW TO USE

5-10 mL twice daily

⚠ PRECAUTIONS

- May cause drowsiness
- Do not drive after taking

SIDE EFFECTS

- Sleepiness
- Dry mouth

SEE A DOCTOR IF

- Cough persists for more than 7 days
- Cough is accompanied by high fever or green phlegm

Diarrhea

Imodium

OTC

Loperamide

USED FOR

- Acute watery diarrhea

HOW TO USE

As needed

⚠ PRECAUTIONS

- Do not use if fever is present
- Do not use if blood is present in stool

SIDE EFFECTS

- Constipation
- Dizziness
- Abdominal discomfort

SEE A DOCTOR IF

- Fever with diarrhea
- Blood in stool

Eye Care

Refresh Tears

OTC

Carboxymethylcellulose 0.5%

USED FOR

- Dry eyes
- Eye irritation
- Tired eyes

HOW TO USE

1-2 drops in each eye as needed

⚠ PRECAUTIONS

- Do not touch the dropper tip to the eye
- Discard 30 days after opening

SIDE EFFECTS

- Temporary blurred vision

SEE A DOCTOR IF

- Eye pain occurs
- Changes in vision occur
- Irritation worsens or persists for more than 72 hours

First Aid

Hansaplast Washproof

OTC

Adhesive bandage

USED FOR

- Small cuts
- Minor abrasions

HOW TO USE

Apply as needed

⚠ PRECAUTIONS

- Clean and dry wound before application
- Change dressing daily or when wet

SIDE EFFECTS

SEE A DOCTOR IF

- Signs of infection appear (redness, warmth, pus)
- Wound is deep or gaping

Fungal Infection

Candid Dusting Powder

OTC

Clotrimazole 1%

USED FOR

- Sweat rash
- Ringworm
- Athlete's foot

HOW TO USE

Apply twice daily to affected area

⚠ PRECAUTIONS

- For external use only

SIDE EFFECTS

- Mild skin irritation

SEE A DOCTOR IF

- Condition worsens
- No improvement after 2 weeks of use

Muscle Pain

Volini

OTC

Diclofenac

USED FOR

- Muscle pain
- Sprains

HOW TO USE

Apply topically as needed

⚠ PRECAUTIONS

- Wash hands after application

SIDE EFFECTS

- Local skin irritation
- Redness at application site

SEE A DOCTOR IF

- Condition does not improve after 7 days
- Severe skin irritation develops

Nasal Congestion

Otrivin Oxy

OTC

Oxymetazoline Hydrochloride

USED FOR

- Blocked nose

HOW TO USE

Use as directed

⚠ PRECAUTIONS

- Do not use for more than 3-5 consecutive days

SIDE EFFECTS

- Rebound congestion with prolonged use

SEE A DOCTOR IF

- Congestion persists after 3 to 5 days of use
- Nasal bleeding occurs

Pain & Fever

Dolo 650

OTC

Paracetamol 650 mg

USED FOR

- Fever
- Pain

HOW TO USE

As needed

⚠ PRECAUTIONS

- Do not exceed maximum daily limit
- Avoid alcohol consumption

SIDE EFFECTS

SEE A DOCTOR IF

- Fever persists for more than 3 days
- Pain persists for more than 10 days

Pain & Inflammation

Combiflam

OTC

Ibuprofen 400 mg + Paracetamol 325 mg

USED FOR

- Body aches
- Joint pain
- Headache
- Muscle sprains

HOW TO USE

1 tablet after food, up to twice daily

⚠ PRECAUTIONS

- Do not take on an empty stomach
- Avoid if you have dengue

SIDE EFFECTS

- Acidity
- Stomach upset

SEE A DOCTOR IF

- Fever persists for more than 3 days
- Pain persists for more than 10 days

Rehydration

Electral

OTC

Oral Rehydration Salts

USED FOR

- Dehydration
- Diarrhea
- Heat exhaustion

HOW TO USE

Use as directed on sachet

⚠ PRECAUTIONS

- Reconstitute only in safe, potable water
- Do not boil the reconstituted solution
- Discard unused solution after 24 hours

SIDE EFFECTS

SEE A DOCTOR IF

- Diarrhea lasts more than 24 hours
- Signs of severe dehydration appear
- Inability to keep oral fluids down

Sore Throat

Strepsils

OTC

Amylmetacresol + Dichlorobenzyl Alcohol

USED FOR

- Sore throat
- Scratchy throat

HOW TO USE

1 lozenge every 3-4 hours

⚠ PRECAUTIONS

- Do not chew the lozenges

SIDE EFFECTS

SEE A DOCTOR IF

- Sore throat persists for more than 2 days
- Accompanied by fever, headache, or nausea

Wound Care

Betadine Ointment

OTC

Povidone-Iodine 10%

USED FOR

- Cuts
- Scrapes
- Minor burns

HOW TO USE

Apply a thin layer after cleaning the wound

⚠ PRECAUTIONS

- Do not use if allergic to iodine

SIDE EFFECTS

- Temporary skin discoloration

SEE A DOCTOR IF

- Deep or puncture wounds
- Animal bites
- Serious burns
- Signs of infection appear

General Safety Rules

1. Responsible OTC Use

Over-the-counter (OTC) medicines treat symptoms, not underlying diseases. If symptoms persist beyond a few days, stop self-medicating and seek medical advice.

2. Antibiotics & Steroids

Never self-prescribe antibiotics or steroid creams. Improper use leads to antibiotic resistance and severe skin thinning. Only take these under direct medical supervision and always complete the full course as prescribed.

3. Storage & Expiry

- Store all medicines in a cool, dry place away from direct sunlight.
- Keep out of reach of children and pets.
- Never consume expired medicines. Check dates every 6 months and discard safely.

4. Hydration

When battling fevers, diarrhoea, or vomiting, maintaining hydration is often more critical than the medication itself. Use ORS (Oral Rehydration Salts) rather than plain water to replenish electrolytes.

5. When Self-Medication is Inappropriate

Proceed immediately to a clinic or ER if you experience: chest pain, sudden severe headache, difficulty breathing, unexplainable rash, sustained high fever ($>103^{\circ}\text{F}/39.4^{\circ}\text{C}$), or confusion.

Disclaimer: This handbook is for informational purposes only and does not replace professional medical advice, diagnosis, or treatment.